

GOOD

GOODProjects: Proven Crime Suppression, Ready to Scale

Since 2019, **GOODProjects** has delivered measurable results in the Southwest Public Housing Community (“**GOODZone**”), an area long overlooked by major investments. Over the past six years, violent crime in the **GOODZone** has not only remained lower than in neighboring hotspots like Navy Yard and the Wharf, but has declined at a faster rate than citywide averages. In 2023, violent crime peaked at 52 cases; by 2024 that number dropped to 29, and in 2025 we are tracking just 16 incidents year-to-date. By contrast, Navy Yard has averaged more than 100 violent crimes annually, while the Wharf has remained flat with little improvement.

These outcomes matter because the **GOODZone** serves a far more vulnerable population: families in public housing, with lower income and education levels than residents of Navy Yard or the Wharf. Despite these challenges—and without significant city funding—**GOODProjects** has built a model that works. We pioneered the Credible Messenger Initiative, now the District’s standard for youth intervention, and continue to deliver programs that reduce violence, build opportunity, and restore community safety.

The imbalance in public investment is stark. Georgetown’s Jelleff Boys & Girls Club has historically received \$610,000 in annual city support, and the Southeast Tennis & Learning Center is in the midst of an \$18 million taxpayer-funded expansion. Yet communities like Southwest, where need is greatest and outcomes are proven, remain underfunded. **GOODProjects** currently has \$88,000 remaining this quarter, with a burn rate of \$90,000 per month—leaving the future of these life-changing programs in jeopardy.

We are requesting a **\$1.5 million annual investment from the District of Columbia**. This investment would sustain programming in the **GOODZone** (\$500,000) and replicate our proven model in the Wharf (\$500,000) and Navy Yard (\$500,000), where crime remains disproportionately high. For the cost of maintaining one underutilized facility, the city can empower a Black-led, community-based solution that is delivering results today and can scale tomorrow.

GOODProjects has demonstrated that community-driven programming is not only effective, but essential. With the District’s partnership, we can expand these proven strategies to meet the growing demand—and ensure that investments in safety are not limited to stadiums and waterfronts, but extend to the people who need them most.

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